All 7 Deadly Sins Committed at a Church Bake Sale

By The Onion Staff

NARRATOR: **(Pg 101-105)** The Onion is a satirical newspaper that originated in Madison, Wisconsin. In a typical issue, the paper pokes fun at everything from Politics . . . "Poll Finds Most Americans Would Swap Democracy for $100 Best Buy Gift Card" * *(Original text reads "Bush Extremely Proud of New Suit")* to Entertainment . . . "NRA Accuses 'Rust' Producers of Endangering Crew by Not Giving Everyone Guns" * *(Original text reads American lifestyles "TV Helps Build Valuable Looking Skills")* from The Environment . . . "Climate Summit sets Ambitious Goal to Phase Out Fossil Fuels by the Time the Earth Runs Out of Them." * *(Original text reads Medicine "Colonoscopy Offers Non-Fantastic Voyage through Human Body")* to Religion, which is what this selection is about . . . Sort of . . . [See] According to the Catholic Church, there are basically two types of sins. "Venial" ones that are easily forgiven and "deadly" ones that well, are not. Pride, Envy, Wrath, Sloth, Avarice (or Greed), Gluttony and Lust -- The Seven Deadlies . . .

INTRODUCTION

No one is safe . . . Anywhere (Evil laughter)

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And now reporting to you live from Gadsden, Alabama . . .

REPORTER: The seven deadly sins—avarice, sloth, envy, lust, gluttony, pride, and wrath—were all committed Sunday during the twice-annual bake sale at St. Mary's of the Immaculate Conception Church. Patti George (far right) commits the sin of envy as she eyes fellow parishioner Mary Hoechst's superior strawberry rhubarb pie. In total, 347 individual acts

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of sin were committed at the bake sale, with nearly every attendee committing at least one of the seven deadly sins as outlined by Gregory the Great in the Fifth Century.

CONNIE BARRETT: *(full of pride)* My cookies, cakes, and brownies are always the highlight of our church bake sales, and everyone says so. Sometimes, even I'm amazed by how well my goodies turn out.

REPORTER: Fellow parishioner Betty Wicks, who commits the sin of gluttony at every St. Mary's bake sale, as well as most Friday nights at Old Country Buffet, agreed.

BETTY WICKS: *(245 lbs and committing the sin of gluttony)* Every time I go past Connie's table, I just have to buy something. I simply can't help myself—it's all so delicious.

REPORTER: The popularity of Barrett's mouth-watering wares elicited the sin of envy in many of her fellow vendors.

GEORGIA BRANDT: Connie has this fantastic book of recipes her grandmother gave her, and she won't share them with anyone. This year, I made white-chocolate blondies and thought they'd be a big hit. But most people just went straight to Connie's table, got what they wanted, and left. All the while, Connie just stood there with this look of smug satisfaction on her face. It took every ounce of strength in my body to keep from going over there and really telling her off.

REPORTER: While the sins of wrath and avarice were each committed dozens of times at the event, Barrett and longtime bake sale rival Penny Cox brought them together in full force.

CONNIE BARRETT: Penny said she wanted to make a bet over whose table would make the most money. Whoever lost would have to sit in the dunk tank at the St. Mary's Summer Fun Festival. I figured it's for such a good cause, a little wager couldn't hurt. Besides, I always bring the church more money anyway, so I couldn't possibly lose.

REPORTER: Moments after agreeing to the wager, Cox became wrathful when Barrett, the bake sale's co-chair, grabbed the best table location under the pretense of having to keep the coffee machine full. Cox attempted to exact revenge by reporting an alleged Barrett misdeed to the church's priest.

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PENNY COX: I mentioned to Father Mark that I've seen candles at Connie's house that I wouldn't be surprised one bit if she stole from the church's storage closet.

REPORTER: Cox also committed the sin of sloth by forcing her daughter to set up and man her booth while she gossiped with friends.

PENNY COX: Perhaps if he investigates this, by this time next year, Connie won't be co-chair of the bake sale; and in her place, we'll have someone who's willing to rotate the choice table spots.

REPORTER: The sin of lust also reared its ugly head at the bake sale, largely due to the presence of Melissa Wyckoff, a shapely 20-year-old redhead whose family recently joined the church. *(Actor 2 pantomimes Wyckoff)* While male attendees ogled Wyckoff, the primary object of lust for females was the personable, boyish Father Mark. Though attendees' feelings of lust for Wyckoff and O'Connor were never acted on, they did not go unnoticed. After Jilly Brandon's husband Craig offered Wyckoff on of her Rice Krispie treats . . . to "welcome her to the parish"

JILLY BRANDON: There's something not right about that Melissa Wyckoff. She might have just moved here from California, but that red dress of hers should get her kicked out of the church.

REPORTER: According to St. Mary's treasurer Beth Ellen Coyle, informal church-sponsored events are a notorious breeding ground for the seven deadly sins.

BETH ELLEN COYLE: Bake sales, haunted houses, pancake breakfasts . . . such church events are rife with potential for sin. This year, we had to eliminate the 'Guess Your Weight' booth from the annual church carnival because the envy and pride had gotten so out of hand. Church events are about glorifying God, not violating His word. If you want to do that, you're no better than that cheap strumpet Melissa Wyckoff.

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SOURCE INFORMATION

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